

- Reinforce your savings goal/s
- Question your spending decisions
- Update you on your savings progress
- Discuss your finances openly, without judgement
- Analyse your spending habits while living on pocket money. Can you cut back more as you learn to live on less, or do you need extra each week to meet your obligations without stress?
- Release additional one-off funds to you if you need to make a purchase that is outside the budget; having to request the cash will stay your hand if it's a wasteful buy.

The role of the gatekeeper is to mind your money, but not to enable you. They are your voice of reason as you learn to respect and value your salary. Eventually, they give you back full responsibility and control of that account, at your request, as a bank or creditor will need to see proof that you are capable of saving before granting a home loan.

This person should be someone you can be brutally honest with. You will likely have a weekly conversation about finances with them. If you are someone who has not been good with managing cash, this is likely to be a confronting exercise.

Find a financial guru

If you decide to invest in a neutral expert to manage your money, you'll be seeking a financial advisor. Here are some places to start your search for one (you might see financial planners referred to; these specialists fall under that category):

- The Financial Planning Association of Australia: fpa.com.au
- Your Best Interests (a program produced by the Association of Financial Advisers): yourbestinterests.com.au
- The Federal Government's MoneySmart website: moneysmart.gov.au. Here you can confirm and crosscheck advisors' qualifications to decide if they are the right fit for you.